



Exporting your blog

com. Same goes for additional themes, CSS edits, etc.

With a self-hosted WordPress.org blog, you get greater control over each and every aspect of your blog. Obviously, this also means you have the added responsibility of looking after your web site (something that WordPress.com does for blogs on your behalf) on a regular basis.

- 1) Before starting the migration process, get yourself a good online web host and register a custom domain name. Check that your new online web host provides a minimum of PHP 4.3, MySQL



Importing into WordPress.org

- 4.0 and the mod_rewrite Apache module.
- 2) Upload the latest installation of WordPress.org on to your web host- follow WordPress's "Famous 5-Minute Installa" (<http://bit.ly/zZB29Z>)- and leave the default extracted and installed files untouched.
 - 3) The next step is to go to the

to upload it on to your new blog may vary. If all goes well, you're done migrating your blog from one place to another.

Burn your site feeds on Feedburner

When we say burn, we don't mean it literally, of course. But yeah, one of the few things you

Tools section of your WordPress.com blog and click on Export. On the resulting screen you're asked to tick radio buttons on the fields you'd like to export from your current WordPress.com blog - stuff like categories, posts, pages, etc. Make sure you click on all radio

buttons to ensure everything from your WordPress.com blog is copied over to your recently created WordPress.org blog. Download the resulting WXR or WordPress eXtended RSS file on to your computer.

- 4) The last step in this process is to head over to the control panel of your WordPress.org blog and click on the Tools menu item. Hit on import and upload the WXR file you downloaded from your WordPress.com blog. Depending on the size of this file and your connection speed, the time taken

should do immediately after setting up a spiffy new blog is to submit it at Feedburner, a Google service that only helps manage your web feeds - nothing else - and it does so better than any other software or web tool we know of. And yes, all for free, of course, as we've come to expect from Google.

This is how you go about submitting your blog's feed to Feedburner. First of all, you need to have a Feedburner account. Since Google bought Feedburner back in 2007, you can login in with your most-used Gmail account credentials is allowed (unless you want to create a separate Google login just for your blog's feed management service).

After log into Feedburner, choose what type of blog software you use - is it a self-hosted WordPress blog? A WordPress.com blog? Or a Blogger web site? Clicking on the relevant radio button leads to the next step.

Here you enter your blog feed's URL into one of the two fields. If you don't know where your blog's RSS feed is located, don't worry. Just enter your blog's URL and Feedburner will auto-detect the RSS feed's location. The final step is to choose a unique feeds.feedburner.com/your-feed URL to locate your feed online.

That's it. Once that is done, you can now track your RSS feed subscription data through Feedburner. Not only this, you can also easily offer email subscription for your feed through a feedburner plugin installed in your WordPress blog. Feedburner also offers in-depth analytics and AdSense integration. The whole thing looks

more professional than WordPress' own feed engine.

Highlight keywords in search results

How many times have you performed a keyword search in a blog's search field only to see a long list of matching posts to sift through without any visual clues? Not many, we're sure. So when you run a blog with a lot of posts and a sizable fan following, do a favour on visitors coming to your blog and searching for specific posts or words across your blog.

The least you can do is highlight the search keyword in the search result page for readers to easily find what they're looking for. Here's how:

- 1) Open your WordPress installation's `search.php` file and search for the following code:

```
<?php the_title(); ?>
```
- 2) Replace it with:

```
<?php echo $title; ?>
```
- 3) And finally paste the following chunk of code before the title code we just replaced above:

```
<?php $title = get_the_title();  
$keys= explode(" ", $s); $title  
= preg_replace('/\./i', implode(' ',  
$keys) . 'iu', ' <strong  
class="search-excerpt">\O</  
strong>'. $title); ?>
```

The last step is to tweak your blog's CSS file `search-excerpt` and add styling for the search highlight keyword.



Notice the highlited words